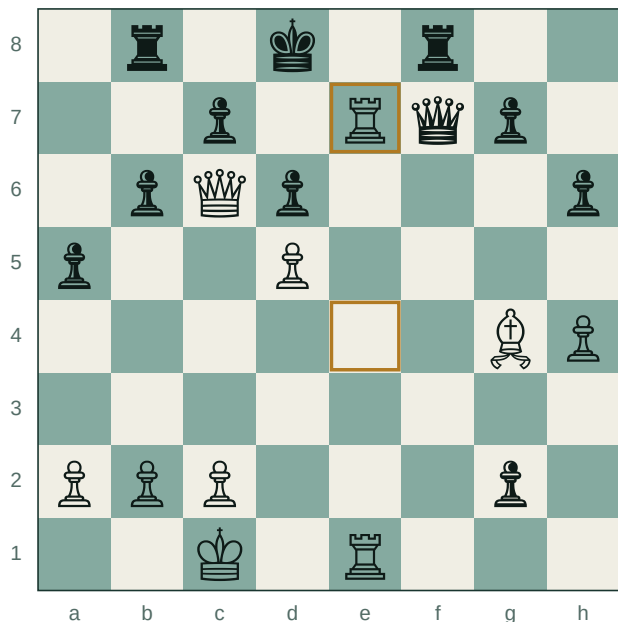


Promotion combinations: Black, move 32

Promotion combinations

Black to move



Previous move: 32.Re7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

32...Qxe7 33. Rxe7 g1=Q+

32...Qxe7 The queen captures the rook on e7. Recorded reply: **33.Rxe7**.

33...g1=Q+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen. From g1 it attacks king on c1 and bishop on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on c1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on g4. Check for tactical protection.